

The Expertise Imperative: What AI Can't Replace

40%

Just 2% dehydration slows your brain by 40%. Dehydrated professionals made 101 driving errors — versus 48 for legally drunk drivers. Your performance edge starts with biology, not strategy.

Bedford University Study — Milo Wilkinson, AIME 2026 Keynote

01

The Human Edge Is the Only Edge

AI automates tasks. Humans create meaning.

30%

of current skills eradicated by 2030 — but 10 of 12 top future skills are human

In Biosphere 2, trees grew fast in a protected environment — then fell over. Without wind, they never deepened their roots. **AI is your wind.** The disruption you fear is the force that makes you irreplaceable.

02

Resilience Is Trainable, Not Optional

The science says your brain works against you. The practice says you can override it.

30%

increase in customer satisfaction AND profit from 12 months of EQ training alone

73% of thoughts are baseline negative. 92-95% repeat tomorrow. Kristina Karlsson chose "lucky me" the day she lost her \$650M business. **Elite performers recognise the loop — and jump anyway.**

03

Delight Is the New Competitive Moat

Perfection is forgettable. Surprise is an appreciating asset.

257%

attendee growth at Token 2049 through FOMO architecture and designed surprise

39,800 matchmaking connections. 16,200 meetings. The "vibe checker" — a human who reads the room and overrides the run sheet — represents **the future of event roles.**

|| We're not afraid of change at all. We're afraid of loss. And every time change is upon us, we go straight to what it is that we're about to lose.

Milo Wilkinson, Neuroscientist — AIME 2026 Keynote

3 ACTIONS FOR Q2 2026

Run a Triple-Threat Audit

Score your team on Mindset, Skillset, and Toolset. If 75% of success is mindset, that's where investment should start.

Design One Peak Moment

Stop optimising for seamlessness. Pick one 15-minute experience that surprises. That memory defines the event.

Schedule Recovery Like Meetings

Block 3-5 weekly slots for energy recovery. Critical decisions before 2pm. Your battery matters more than your calendar.